

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel, Defender and Azure Security Architecture

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of demonstrable experience owning cybersecurity controls, incident response, threat monitoring and vulnerability management across Windows Server and Azure infrastructure. I have deep hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel (including Kusto Query Language (KQL) rule authoring), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender, as well as Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Public Key Infrastructure (PKI), Single Sign-On (SSO) and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA). I am adept at strengthening an organisation's overall security posture through detection engineering, proactive threat hunting and close collaboration with Infrastructure Operations and technology teams - translating technical findings into clear risk-rated recommendations for senior stakeholders. I hold CISSP certification and am comfortable operating at the intersection of security architecture and hands-on security engineering within a complex professional services environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) - custom analytics rules, workbooks, automation playbooks; CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; Splunk
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender - 8,000+ user deployment
- **Azure and Windows Infrastructure Security:** Microsoft Azure, Windows Server, Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Group Policy, PKI, SSO
- **Identity and Access Management:** MFA, SSO, Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, Zero Trust architecture
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response framework, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, full incident lifecycle from detection through containment, eradication and lessons learned
- **Threat Monitoring and Threat Hunting:** Proactive threat hunting using SIEM telemetry and endpoint data; threat intelligence integration and Indicators of Compromise (IoC) analysis
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) - risk-prioritised remediation reporting
- **Security Architecture:** Security controls design, architecture review, hardening of hybrid Azure and on-premises environments
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Compliance and Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), SC-100 / SC-200 aligned knowledge, CompTIA A+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer - University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

- Own cybersecurity controls and security architecture across a hybrid Azure and Windows Server environment supporting over 8,000 users; report to the Head of Cyber Security and Infrastructure and work closely with Infrastructure Operations and broader technology teams
- Design and maintain Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules, analytics workbooks and SOAR automation playbooks to identify threats, reduce alert noise and accelerate incident response
- Operate Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender as the organisation's unified Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platform, investigating

alerts and performing deep-dive threat analysis

- Manage Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policies, MFA, SSO and Group Policy; enforce Zero Trust access controls across identities, devices and cloud workloads
- Administer Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) and certificate lifecycle management, ensuring integrity and confidentiality of communications across the organisation
- Lead incident response end-to-end under the NIST 800-61 framework - from initial detection and triage through containment, eradication and post-incident review, with board-level reporting on significant events
- Conduct proactive threat monitoring and threat hunting using SIEM telemetry and endpoint data, mapping adversary behaviour to MITRE ATT&CK techniques and recommending defensive countermeasures
- Manage vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Nessus; produce risk-prioritised remediation reports and track progress against agreed SLAs with infrastructure teams
- Oversee Privileged Access Management (PAM) using BeyondTrust, governing access to critical Windows Server and Azure infrastructure in line with least-privilege principles
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon for EDR, endpoint prevention and discovery across the estate, tuning detection policies and investigating host-level threats
- Contribute to security architecture reviews, infrastructure hardening initiatives and technology uplift projects, identifying vulnerabilities and proposing risk-appropriate controls

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity - University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

- Performed day-to-day threat monitoring and incident response using Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender and CrowdStrike Falcon; investigated alerts, escalated high-severity incidents and documented findings
- Authored and refined Microsoft Sentinel KQL queries and detection rules to improve coverage of priority threat scenarios across the Azure and Windows Server estate
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) configuration, Conditional Access policies, MFA rollout and SSO integrations to strengthen the organisation's identity security posture
- Carried out regular vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus; tracked remediation progress and communicated risk exposure to the infrastructure team
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM administration, conducting privileged account access reviews and responding to PAM alerts
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials+ compliance activities, including evidence gathering and support for internal and external audits
- Maintained Windows Server hardening baselines and Group Policy configurations in line with CIS Controls benchmarks

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure - HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed cybersecurity controls and security architecture for a SaaS/FinTech organisation, supporting incident response, threat monitoring and vulnerability management across cloud and on-premises infrastructure
- Administered identity and access management, MFA, SSO and endpoint security tooling across the organisation's Windows and Azure environment
- Performed vulnerability scans and supported remediation activities, contributing to the organisation's risk management and compliance programme
- Supported infrastructure hardening and security architecture reviews, identifying control gaps and recommending improvements aligned to NIST and CIS Controls frameworks

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and implemented a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel detection rule library using KQL, improving the organisation's ability to identify advanced threats across Azure and Windows Server infrastructure
- Deployed and optimised Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000+ user estate, achieving unified XDR visibility and reducing incident response time

- Led incident response for multiple high-severity security events, containing and eradicating threats with minimal disruption and delivering executive-level post-incident reporting
- Implemented SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel that significantly reduced manual alert handling and standardised the organisation's response to common threat scenarios
- Enforced Zero Trust identity principles through Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access, MFA and BeyondTrust PAM, materially reducing the organisation's privileged account risk exposure
- Drove risk-prioritised vulnerability remediation programme using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, achieving a measurable reduction in exploitable vulnerabilities across the Azure and Windows estate
- Supported ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials+ certification activities, contributing to the organisation achieving and maintaining its compliance posture

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)